It is a structuring principle that automatically governs the formations and interactions of the basic mental and physical elements of existence (***dharma***). Morality requires such organisation because Buddhists deny that there is any persisting entity such as the soul (***atman***) that would link thoughts and actions with their results in this and future lives and which would experience the consequences of ethically significant actions (***karma***). And there is no God who could act as a moral superintendent.

Interdependent origination is sometimes expressed as a twelvefold chain: basic ignorance (***avidya***) conditions karmic dispositions (*samskara*), which condition mental events (*vijnana*), which condition the psycho-physical body (*nama-rupa*), which conditions the sensory receptors, which condition sense–object interactions, which condition feelings (*vedana*), which condition 'thirst' or desire, which conditions craving (*upadana*), which conditions repeated existences (*bhava*), which condition births (***jati***), which condition old age and death (*jara-maranam*) and all our woe.

The ***Madhyamaka*** school, founded by ***Nagarjuna***, interprets *pratitya-samutpada* in terms of the relativity of all conditioned things.

See ***Satkaryavada*** and ***Asatkaryavada***

Further reading: Collins 1982; Gethin 1998; Rahula 1969

**Pratiyogin** (counterpart of an absence or the absentee): when I see that the keys are not on the desk, my mental image of the missing keys is the counterpart of the perceived absence. ***Nyaya-Vaisheshika*** philosophers define an effect as the counterpart of its prior absence.

Further reading: Matilal 1968

**Pratyabhijna** ('Recognition'): Kashmiri school of philosophy connected with a monistic form of Shiva worship.